1 The nature of technology: Computers everyday

You will learn

- what a computer is
- things we can do with computers
- how computers help us.



Computers are part of everyday life. In this unit you will learn what a computer is. You will learn how using computers can help you. You will learn how to stay safe when you are using a computer.



Talk about...

Have you ever seen a computer?

What did the computer look like?

Have you ever used a computer?

What did you use the computer for?



Learning outcomes: Say what a computer is; Say some things that can be done with a computer in school and out of school



Class activity

How can you stay safe and happy when you use computers at school?

Make a golden rule for using computers at school.

Make a poster of your rule.

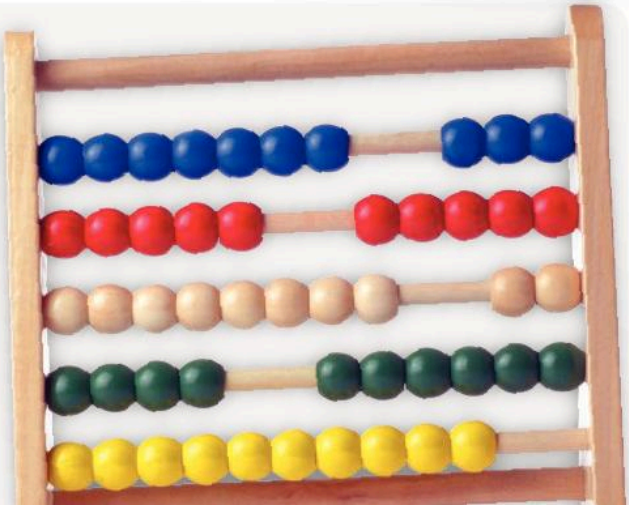
computer **mouse**
screen **keyboard**
laptop **courteous**
technology





Did you know?

Some people think the first computer was an abacus. The abacus was invented more than 2500 years ago in Babylon. An abacus is a counting machine.



1.1 What is technology?

In this lesson

You will learn:

- how computers can help us.

Technology is any machine we can use to solve a problem.

A **computer** is a machine. Computers can do things quickly.

People tell computers what to do. We can use computers to help us...

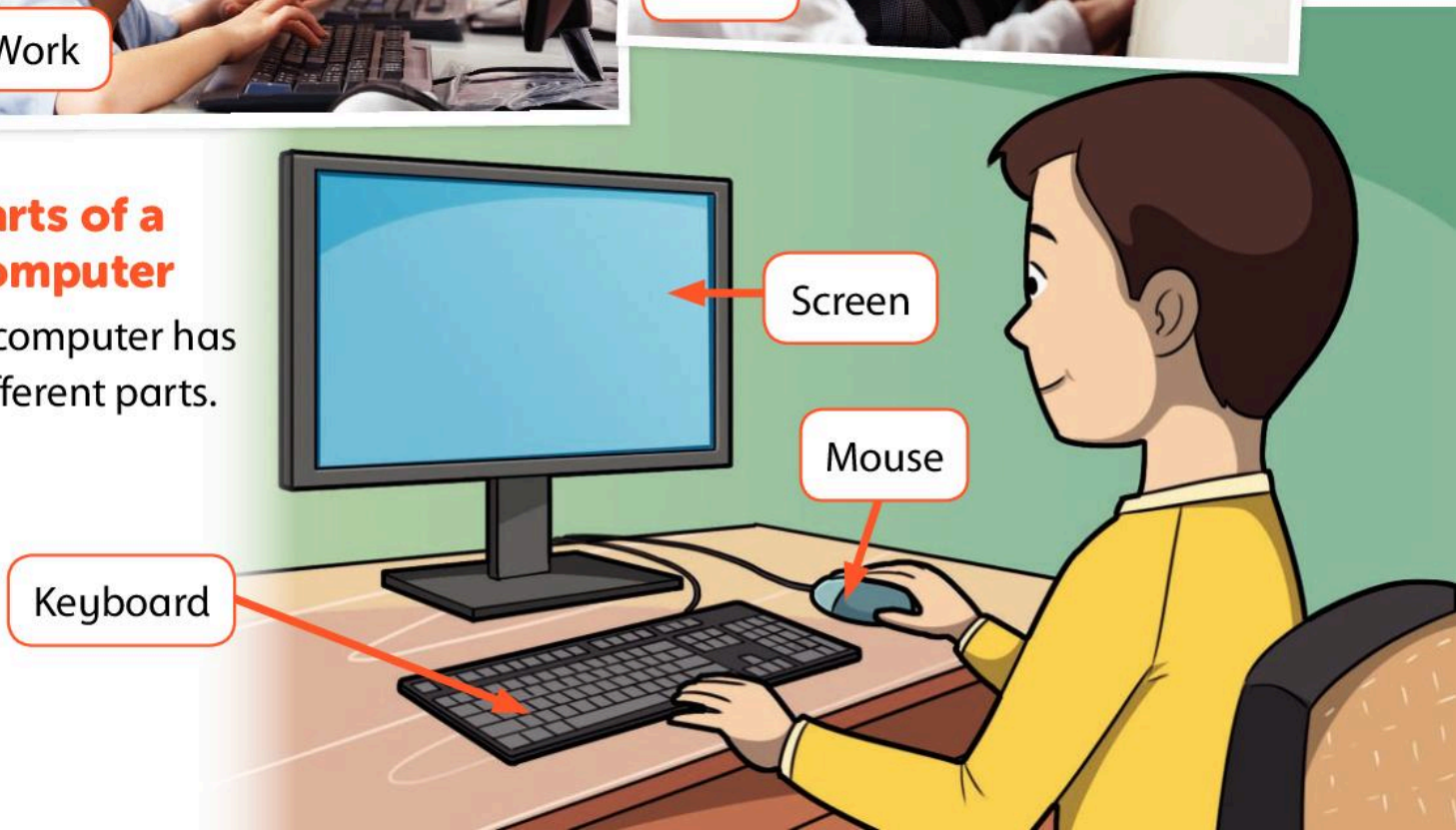




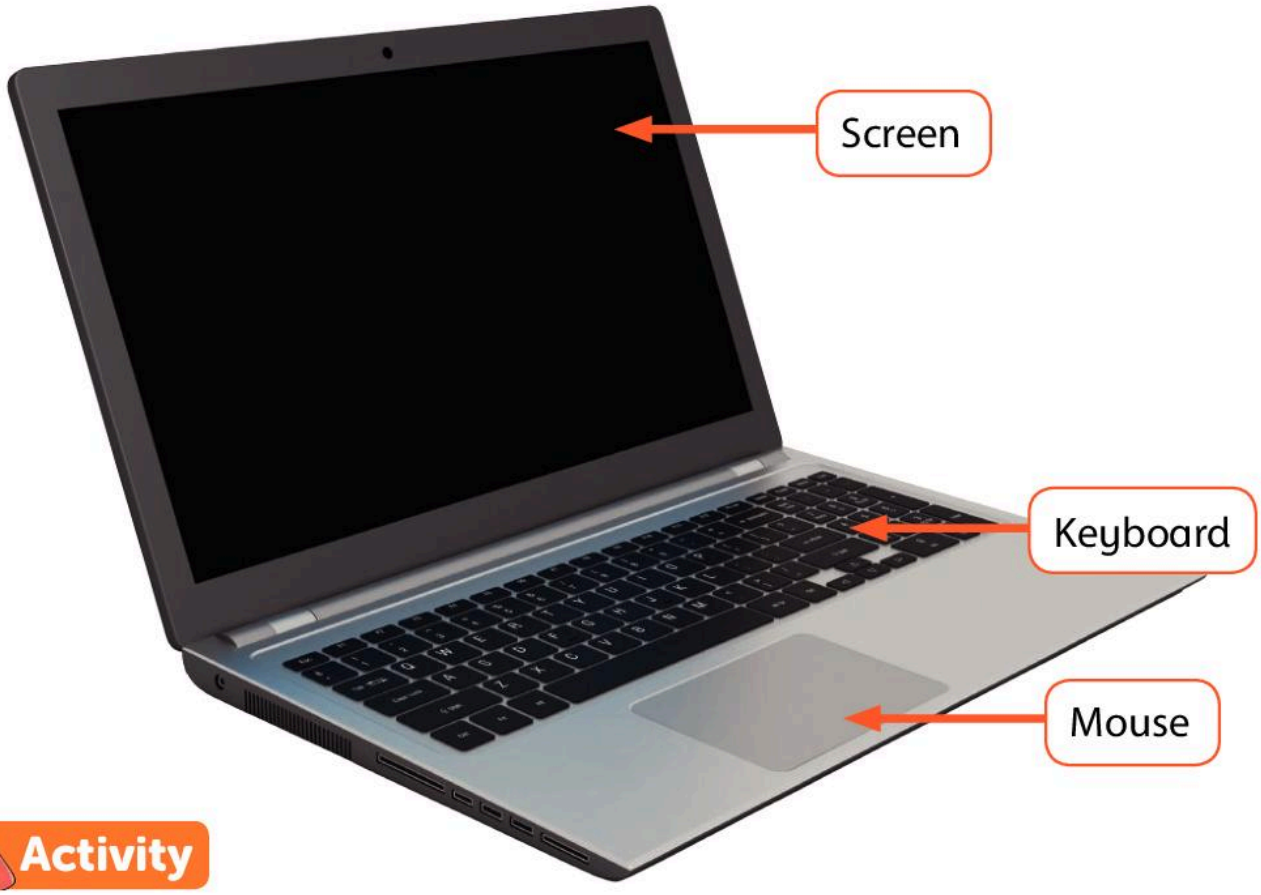


Parts of a computer

A computer has different parts.



This computer looks different. It is a **laptop**.



Activity

Draw a picture of a computer. In your picture, show:

- the screen
- the mouse
- the keyboard.

Extra challenge

What is this?



Explore more

Talk to someone at home about technologies they use. Draw pictures. Bring your pictures to school.

1.2 Staying safe

In this lesson

You will learn:

- how to stay safe when you are using a computer.

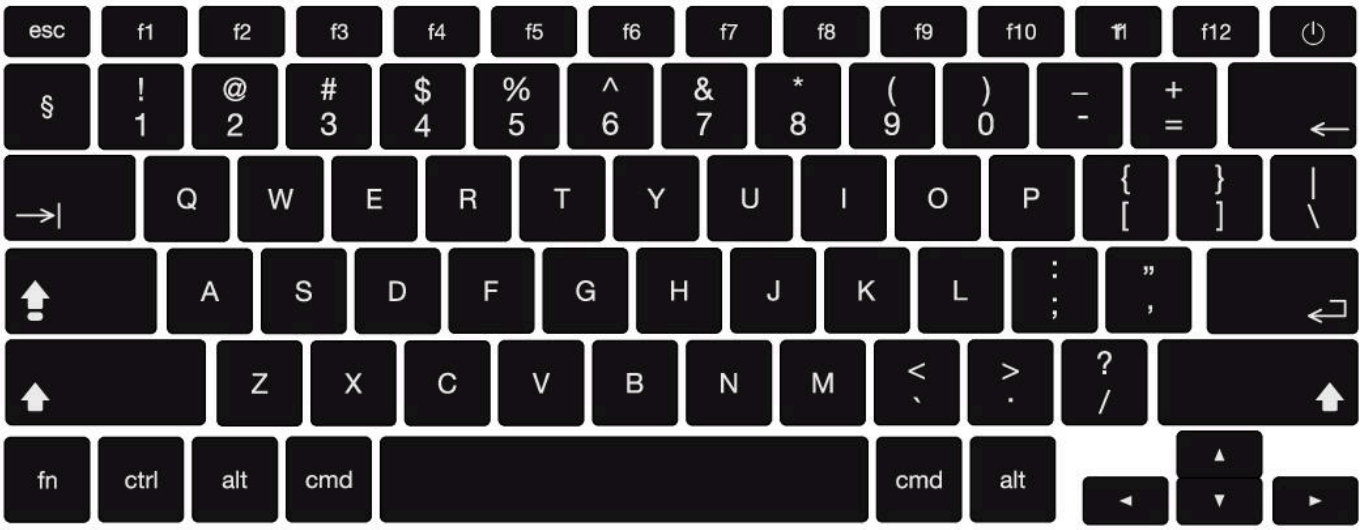


The girl is using a computer.

There is no food or drink near the computer. The girl is sitting on a chair. She can see the **screen**. She can use the **mouse**. She can reach the **keyboard**.

A keyboard has buttons on it.

What can you see on the buttons? Can you see letters, numbers and symbols?



Think again

Is your keyboard like the one in the picture? What is the same? What is different?

Activity

What is wrong with the way these children are using their computers?







Extra challenge

These children are sharing nicely. What could they do to be safer?



1.3 My computing family

In this lesson

You will learn:

- how people use computers at home.

You have asked someone outside school how they use computers. What did they say?

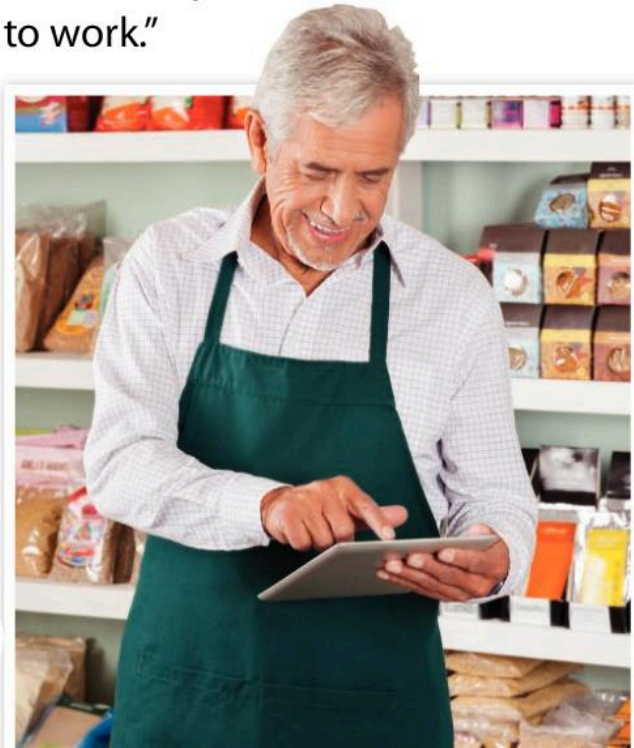
"I use computers to find things out."



"I use computers to play games."



"I use computers to work."



"We use computers to talk to people in our family."



Activity

Draw a picture of one thing you can do with a computer outside school. For example, make a picture of a car.

Give your picture to your teacher.



Extra challenge

What else could you do with a computer outside school?

Think again

How will you use computers when you are grown up?



1.4 Computers in school

In this lesson

You will learn:

- how people use computers in school.



People use computers in different ways in school.

The head teacher uses computers to write letters.

The school librarian uses computers to check books in and out.

The children use computers to help them learn.





The office worker uses a computer to help run the school.

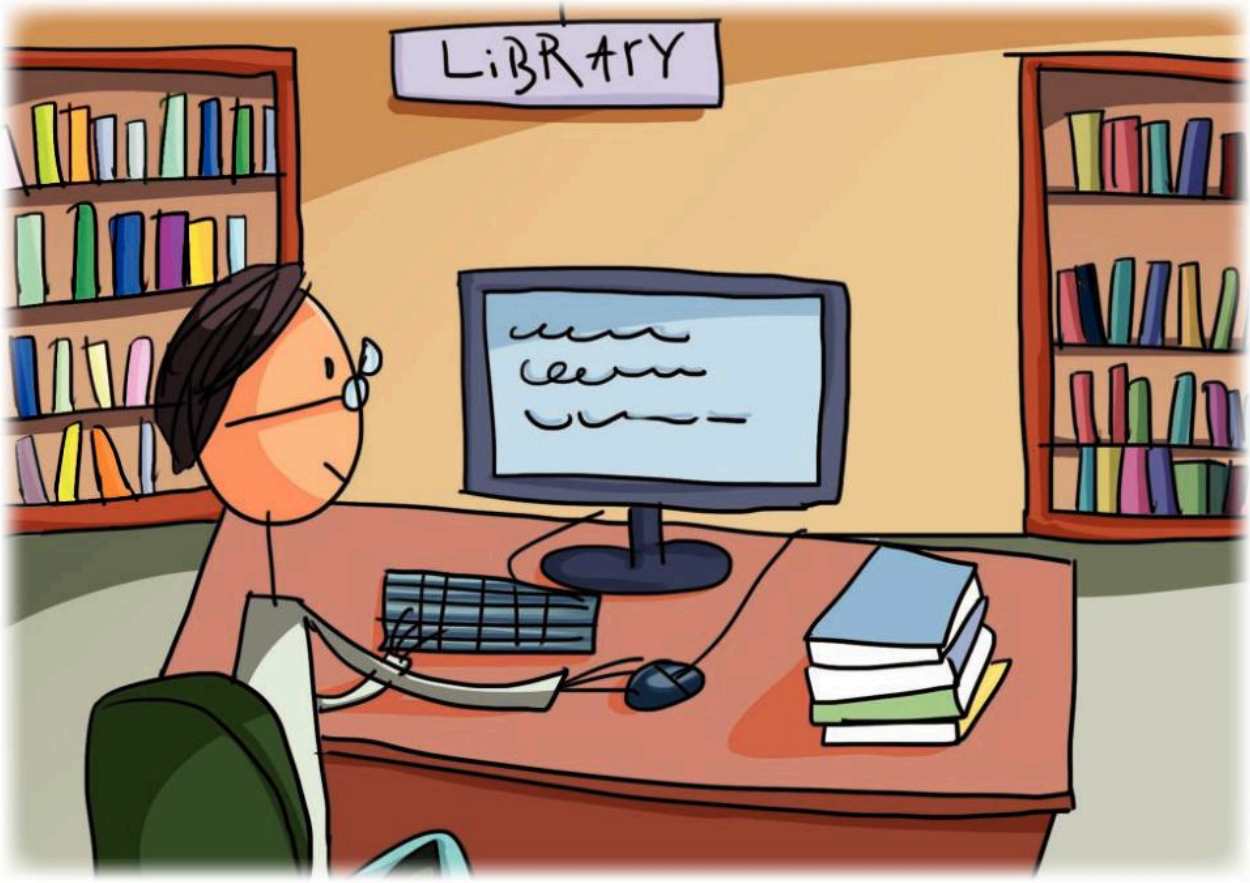


Activity

Walk around the school with some classmates.

Ask the people you meet how they use computers.

Draw pictures of the ways people use computers in school.



Think again

How do you think computers make it easier for adults to do their jobs in school?

Extra challenge

Write one sentence about the ways adults use computers in school.

Digital citizen of the future

Do you think you will use a computer in your job when you are an adult?

1.5 Home and school

In this lesson

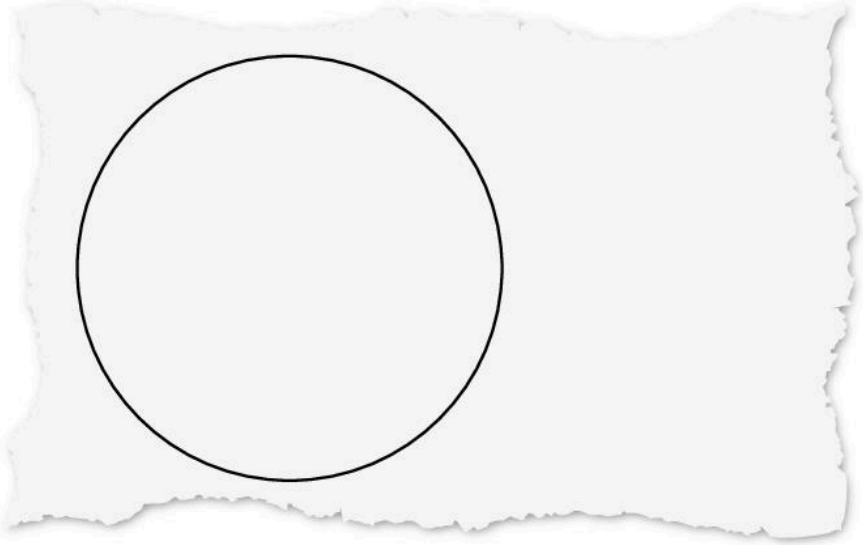
You will learn:

- how to compare the ways people use computers inside and outside school.

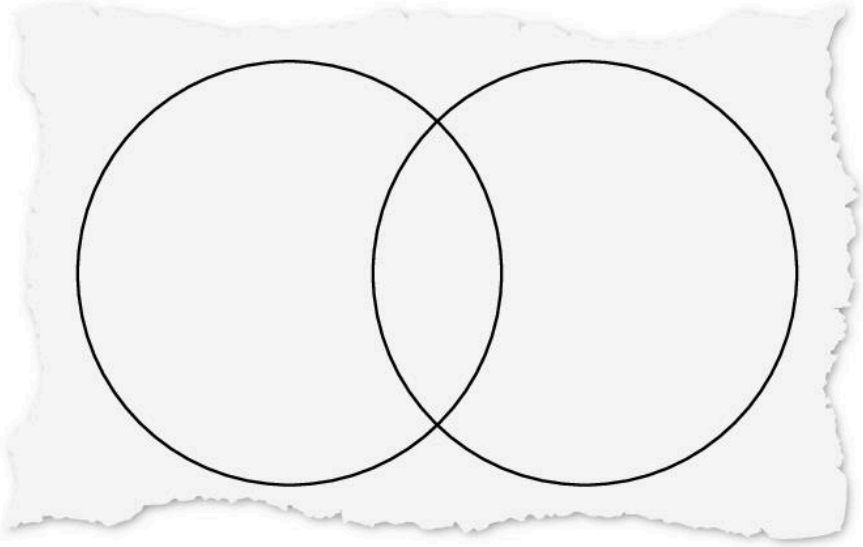


Activity

In a group, draw a big circle on a large piece of paper, like this:



Now draw another big circle like this:



Look at the pictures you have drawn of people using computers.

Put all the pictures of people using computers outside school in one circle.

Put all the pictures of people using computers inside school in the other circle.

How do people use computers inside school?

How do people use computers outside school?







Extra challenge

Which pictures fit inside the middle of the circles?

Think again

What do you like to do on a computer?

1.6 Being courteous

In this lesson

You will learn:

- how to be courteous when you use computers.

Sometimes people use computers to do the wrong thing.

We need to be **courteous** when we use computers. Being courteous means being polite and thinking about other people.



Activity

In a group, talk about these problems. What would you do if:

someone sends you a text message that makes you unhappy?

someone you know answers their phone while you are talking to them?



two people are arguing over one computer?

someone sends you a message with an angry emoji?

Digital citizen of the future

When we use computers we should only write things we would say to the person if they were standing in front of us.

Extra challenge

Have you ever had a problem when you used computers? What was your problem? How did you solve it?



Check what you know

You have learned

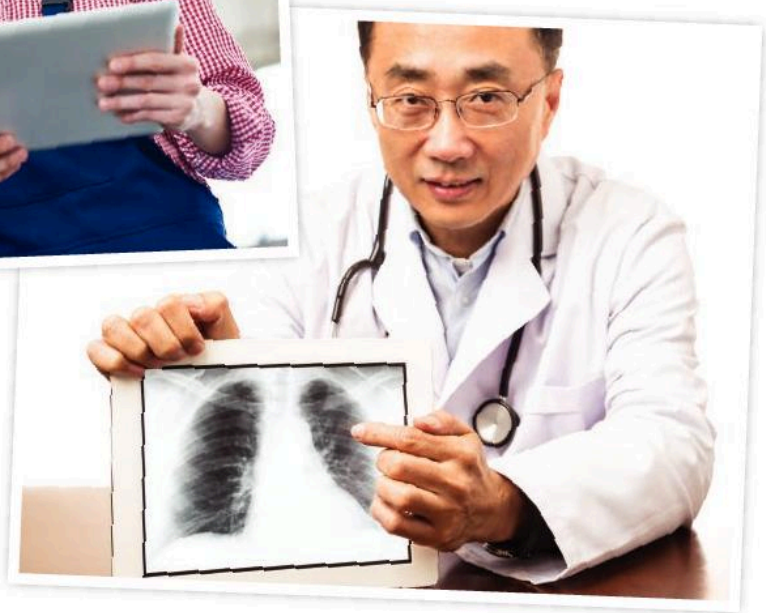
- what a computer is
- things we can do with computers
- how computers help us.

Test

Show or tell to answer these questions.

1. Can you use a computer safely? Show or tell your teacher.
2. Say one way a grown-up might use a computer outside of school.
3. Say how computers can help people.







Activities

1 Draw a picture of:

- a computer screen
- a keyboard
- a computer mouse.

2 Write the names of the computer parts onto your picture.

Self-evaluation

- I answered test question 1.
- I can use a computer at school.
- I answered test questions 1 and 2.
- I did activity 1.
- I answered all the test questions.
- I did activities 1 and 2.

Re-read any parts of the unit you feel unsure about. Try the test and activities again – can you do more this time?